



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Ref:	057	Author:	D Bibby	Date:	07.02.2024
Topic:			Spill Control		

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

The accidental release of oils and other chemicals from construction sites make up a large number of pollution incidents each year.

Many spillages can be prevented, in the event of a spill it is important to control the spill to minimise the effects of the spill.

By doing so we hope to be able to: –

Minimise potential harm: spills can spread quickly and dramatically the environment.

Avoid prosecution: fines and clean-up costs as a result of a spill can be expensive.

Public relations: avoid negative publicity for the company and clients.

Do make sure your aware of the location of spill control equipment and that it is adequately stocked.

In the event of a spill:

1. STOP WORK immediately
2. If spillage is flammable, extinguish all possible sources of ignition.
3. Identify the source of the spill and attempt to remedy.
4. Inform Site Manager immediately
5. Wear appropriate PPE.
6. Protect sensitive areas (e.g. watercourses or surface water drains – use drain covers or construct a bund
7. Clean up the spill. Use absorbent granules/pads to mop up spills. Large polls of oil or spills which cannot be absorbed should be contained and the Site Manager informed immediately.
8. Dispose of all contaminated materials (soil/absorbent materials) correctly – those containing substances such as oil, diesel or paint will be hazardous waste. Ensure any contaminated water is taken to an appropriately licensed disposal site.

DON'T ignore it!!! Stop work and act immediately.

DON'T hide the incident – ensure you report and implement controls.

DON'T ever hose a spill into the drainage system.

Always use absorbent materials

**Discussion Points**

Do you know where or how to get hold of absorbent pads / spill kits in your workplace?

Do you know the correct PPE to wear when dealing with spills?